



r/IGCSE Resources

Guide to Cambridge IGCSE™ and O Level
Literature in English
(0475/2010)

by slimy

1st edition, for examination until 2025

Overview

IGCSE English literature 0475 is divided into two papers; paper 1(poetry and prose) and paper 2(drama). The syllabus enables learners to read, interpret and evaluate texts through the study of literature in English. Learners develop an understanding of literal meaning, relevant contexts and of the deeper themes or attitudes that may be expressed. Through their studies, they learn to recognise and appreciate the ways in which writers use English to achieve a range of effects, and will be able to present an informed, personal response to the material they have studied. The syllabus also encourages the exploration of wider and universal issues, promoting learners' better understanding of themselves and of the world around them.

Paper 1: Poetry and Prose

You are given 2 questions to answer within 1 hour and 30 minutes. It is ideal to spend 35–40 minutes per question and to leave 5–10 minutes per question for checking.

Section A: Poetry. You are given choices between different poems and you must answer the one you have studied. For the poetry section you are required to answer **one** question only.

Section B: Prose. You are given choices between many extracts and you must attempt the prose you have studied. In prose there is an option between an extract based question and a thematic based question. In an extract question you must **only** use quotes based on the extract you are given and in a thematic based question you must support your answer based on quotes you may pick out throughout the prose.

Section A:

Example poem: On finding a Small Fly Crushed in a Book

Some hand, that never meant to do thee hurt,
Has crush'd thee here between these pages pent;
But thou hast left thine own fair monument,
Thy wings gleam out and tell me what thou wert:

...

The closing book may stop our vital breath,
Yet leave no lustre on our page of death.

– Charles Tennyson Turner

Question: How does Turner successfully create a dramatic and emotional effect on the reader in the poem "On Finding a Small Fly Crushed in a Book?"

Format for analysing poems: Introduction, 3–5 PEEL(point, evidence, explanation and link) paragraphs and a conclusion.

Introduction: In the introduction you must start out with an overview of the poem which includes the name of the poem, who wrote it and some background information. *"The poem 'On Finding a Small Fly Crushed in a Book' written by Charles Turner reflects about the inevitability of death and the memories humans leave behind after they die."*

Next you must explain what you are going to analyse in this essay, such as literary devices, themes, tones, moods and rhyme schemes. *"Turner successfully brings out the theme of 'Inevitability of death' by using literary*

devices such as metaphors, hyperboles, apostrophe and enjambment in this poem. He has also used biblical allusion to highlight purity and power." In your introduction you may also refer to the personal response of the poet and how it creates a dramatic effect on the reader. *"The poet expresses his will to create good memories that will leave a powerful mark behind using symbolic representation such as the wings of the fly."*

Your introduction should be no more than 6–7 sentences or 4–5 longer sentences, as most of what you are analysing is in the PEEL paragraphs.

PEEL paragraphs: PEEL stands for point, evidence, explanation and link, you may also use alternatives such as PEAL or PETAL which are similar to PEEL.

Point: Your point must be like a topic sentence, something that summarises what you are going to explain in your paragraph. *"Turner begins the poem with a tone of sadness and uses the literary devices alliteration and enjambment to express his feelings."* Your point should not be more than one sentence.

Evidence: The evidence is the quote(s) you pick out from the extract, they should not be very long. An ideal length for a quote would be 1–2 lines. Writing down quotes that are 3 lines long will just reduce the time you get for analysing the quote instead. *"But thou hast left thine own fair monument thy wings gleam out and tell me what thou wert."*

Explanation: This is the **key** factor that can fetch you marks. You must analyse almost everything that is related to the question, examiners look for: literary devices, symbolism, background information, rhyme schemes, tone, mood and meter.

Your explanation must analyse the implicit and explicit meaning of the quote. *"The poet brings out an uplifting and positive tone when describing the fly's wings which can also symbolise the positivity a person can bring depending on their character."*

You may also use quotes from the quote you selected. *"The poet uses a metaphor when describing the wings of the fly as a 'fair monument' which*

depicts how important and precious those wings were to the fly expressing a tone of respect."

You may also talk about the use of language in the quote. *"The word 'but' is a conditional word which describes a change in thought of the poet followed by a change in the rhyme scheme of the poem. The change in thought could be exemplified as a change in the feeling of the death of the fly, at first the poet was disheartened and now is astonished by the purity of the wings."*

Connections to the theme/tone/mood are always welcome in this paragraph. *"The reference to a monument depicts the importance of the fly and its pure wings which highlights biblical allusion. The poet expresses ideas that the wings are pure as it has not committed any sin, therefore exemplifying the theme of death and legacy."*

In this paragraph you can also talk about the rhyme scheme and meter of the poem, for this one the rhyme scheme is a mixed one: italian sonnet and english sonnet. *"The poet conveys that death will always happen to anyone anytime wherever they are whether they are English or italian."* The meter is: iambic pentameter. *"The use of iambic pentameter brings out a rhythmic effect to the poem complimenting the rhyme scheme of the poem making it more musical."*

You must make sure to describe as much as you can about those 2 lines in one paragraph. If you want to describe the language, look out for the usage of odd words, conditional words or contractions, then connect them to the idea of the poem(inevitability of death) and look out for literary devices to put them together.

Another thing to keep in mind is to not divert from the question. It is important to keep your points within the range of what the question is asking you.

Link: In the link section of your paragraph you must link back to the question you are supposed to answer. *"The mixed emotions of the poet when seeing the death of the fly express to what extent it makes the poem emotional and dramatic."* The best way to link your answers is to give a short summary of

what you just analysed and use that to link it to the question, instead of picking out one small point.

The link part must not deviate from the question or be vague in any terms, you must not say something like *"this makes the poem emotional."* Here the word 'this' is vague as in your explanation section you explained many points related to the quote.

Conclusion: Your conclusion should just summarise what you have answered and in most cases include a personal response(if you have not included one in the introduction). *"Charles Turner has successfully brought out the dramatic effect of the poem using themes of death and legacy and literary devices such as metaphors and apostrophe."*

You may also include symbolisms/allusions/tones/moods/rhyme scheme/meter if you have not included it in your PEEL paragraphs. *"The poet has used a change in rhyme scheme to reflect on the change in thought of Turner creating a change in emotion and a dramatic effect."* Or. *"Turner has used the wings of the fly as a symbolic representation of purity which highlights the idea of the poem: when one flies high their demise is soon."*

You must also include a personal response in the conclusion, something that stands relating to what the poet is trying to say. Do **not** say anything unrelated or contradicting to what the poet is trying to say. *"The poet clearly expresses his idea that when one flourishes we are closer to death so we must strive for knowledge which is showcased in the poem."*

Common mistakes:

1. Do **not** refer to the poet by his/her first name. You can refer to the poet as: the poet, the full name(Charles Tennyson Turner) or the last name(Turner).
2. Use formal language.

"The poet talks about" ❌

"The poet goes on about" ❌

"The poet expresses" ✓

"The poet showcases" ✓

"The poet explains" ✓

"The poet suggests" ✓

3. Do not deviate from what the question is asking. Your points must be in line with what the question is asking.
4. When referring to the poem you must capitalise most of the words. "On Finding a **S**mall **F**ly **C**rushed in a **B**ook." Words such as 'in' or 'a' or any connecting words do not need to be capitalised.
5. Do **not** under analyse or over analyse, your analysis must be related to the question and only have implicit/explicit/background information.
6. Do **not** get the gender of the poet wrong, if you are unsure what the gender of the poet is do not use the pronouns they/them, instead just refer to the poet as "the poet" or "(name)."

Section B:

Overview

Section B in paper 1 of English Literature(O475) you are supposed to answer a question based on the prose you have studied. You are given 2 options, one which is based on an extract and the other based on a certain theme or idea present all across the prose. In BOTH questions you are required to use quotes to support your answer.

Example prose: The Namesake

Q1) In what ways does Lahiri make this such a memorable and significant moment in the novel?

OR

Q2) Explore how Lahiri vividly conveys different attitudes to marriage in *The Namesake*.

How to answer Q1:

This question is based on an extract you are given in the exam, this will be a random passage selected from the book. You must select at least 3–5 quotes from the passage which is related to what the question is asking.

In this example question we are asked how this moment is made “memorable” and “significant.” Underline the key words and understand what the question is asking.

“Memorable” → This means something vitally important or something the main character cherishes. This can also include something that has made an effect on the reader(may include ideas, motifs or certain incidents). This may be seen through characters, themes, language, literary devices, plot and emotions.

“Significant” → This refers to something that holds some sort of importance in the context of the story or something that affects the interpretation of a text. It can also include certain allusions or flashbacks that have an impact on the meaning of the story(may include flashbacks, cultural values, emotions of the character). This can be seen through characters, themes, literary devices, language(narrative techniques), irony and emotions.

Format for analysing prose: Introduction, 3–5 PEEL(point, evidence, explanation and link) paragraphs and a conclusion.

Introduction: In your introduction you explain what the prose is about in 1–2 sentences maximum, anything more than that is a waste of time you could use for the next part of the essay. *“The Namesake, written by Jhumpa Lahiri explores the struggles of an immigrant Bengali family in the United States and their son Gogol. The novel includes his struggle with identity as he grows up in a land foreign to his parents.”*

Then you need to give a short summary on what the passage is about, for example it is about Gogol's first visit to Maxine's house. *"This extract looks into Gogol's first visit to Maxine's house and throughout his visit the author portrays his strong emotions related to the cultural difference between Maxine's household and his."*

Next you must include what you are going to analyse in the essay such as literary devices(focussing on imagery), language techniques, narration, flashbacks, motifs, themes and emotions. *"Lahiri uses literary devices such as imagery to strongly portray Gogol's emotions during his visit. Furthermore the author brings out the theme of 'Indian immigrant' and 'independence' in this extract which makes this moment memorable and significant."*

PEEL paragraphs: PEEL stands for point, evidence, explanation and link, you may also use alternatives such as PEAL or PETAL which are similar to PEEL.

Point: Your point must be like a topic sentence, something that summarises what you are going to explain in your paragraph. It should include language devices or imagery. *"The author uses a flashback technique to highlight Gogol's mixed emotions and the cultural clashes."* Your point should be no more than one sentence.

Evidence: Quote a line or two from the extract you are given, since this is a prose you must select the most suitable quote from the extract making sure it isn't more than 3 lines. Having a quote more than 3 lines will make it hard to analyse the entire quote causing you to have less time for the other paragraphs.

Explanation: This part of your analysis will fetch you the most marks. Your explanation must explain the implicit and explicit meaning of the quote(despite it being a novel). It must also express the emotions of the main character and relating to the themes, tones, moods and motifs. Moreover, you must include language features such as narration and flashback techniques to enhance your response.

You can use imagery as a strong motif to describe Gogol's character and how he describes his surroundings in depth creating a sense of difference in culture. This could also be used to describe Gogol's artistic nature(if required to analyse). *"The author uses imagery to describe the surroundings which expresses Gogol's nervousness and attention to detail as he describes his surroundings. Moreover, the author emphasises on the difference in culture by comparing something as simple as a dinner table. This highlights the theme of 'difference in culture' making this moment significant."*

You can also use flashback techniques to describe Gogol's feelings about his household and his sudden confusion about another unfamiliar household. *"Lahiri uses a language technique known as flashback technique to showcase Gogol's confusion between his household he grew up in and another household he is unfamiliar with. This portrays a strong sense of cultural clashes and unfamiliarity between different households. Furthermore, the author depicts Gogol's nervousness around Maxine's household as a new discovery for Gogol. It shows how Gogol was brought up in an Indian household amongst an American area and his comparisons between how Maxine's house is versus his own house."* You may also give an example, however, it must be something you compare with an incident that has happened in the extract you are given.

You can also use a certain word or a phrase to express Gogol's feelings in this extract. *"The author uses the word 'perplexed' as an idea of confusion. This irregular word could symbolise his mixed emotions at Maxine's house and he is not used to the way their family handles the house. In addition to that, he is shocked by the difference in culture and traditions in their family compared to his own. For example, the freedom Maxine and Gogol get in Maxine's house is different from his own house. In Maxine's house they are able to freely move around unclothed, however, this would not have been the case in his own household."* Note that you must use formal language such as "unclothed" instead of informal words. Any inappropriate words must be avoided at all costs.

Link: In the link section of your paragraph you must link back to the question you are supposed to answer. *"Gogol's emotions visiting Maxine's place showcases how significant this part in the novel is as he depicts his understanding of the cultural clash between his brought up versus his Indian culture."* The best way to link your answers is to give a short summary of what you just analysed and use that to link it to the question, instead of picking out one small point. You can also summarise the effect of language if you have analysed any language techniques to help your analysis.

The link part must not deviate from the question or be vague in any terms, you must not say something like *"this makes this part of the extract significant."* Here the word 'this' is vague as in your explanation section you explained many points related to the quote.

Conclusion: Your conclusion should just summarise what you have answered and in most cases include a personal response(if you have not included one in the introduction). *"Lahiri has successfully made this part of the novel memorable and significant using ideas such as love and marriage as well as Gogol and Maxine's characters to portray this moment to be extremely significant in terms of culture and tradition."*

You must also include any language devices/techniques, symbolism, motifs, themes and ideas you have used in your answer.

How to answer Q2:

Q2) Explore how Lahiri vividly conveys different attitudes to marriage in The Namesake.

This is mostly a thematic based question or a question based on an idea that occurs in the novel. You must use quotes from the novel to support your answer(these can be selected throughout the whole novel). You must have at least 3-5 PEEL paragraphs each having at least 1 quote. It is also not necessary for you to use quotes, however, using quotes strengthens your answers and will make it easier for analysis.

In this question we are being asked about the different attitudes towards marriage in the entire novel. Here you must have at least 3–5 instances where marriage is talked about in the entire novel (which should be different).

Format for analysing prose: Introduction, 3–5 PEEL (point, evidence, explanation and link) paragraphs and a conclusion.

Introduction: In your introduction you explain what the prose is about in 1–2 sentences maximum, anything more than that is a waste of time you could use for the next part of the essay. *“The Namesake, written by Jhumpa Lahiri explores the struggles of an immigrant Bengali family in the United States and their son Gogol. The novel includes his struggle with identity as he grows up in a land foreign to his parents.”*

Next you must give an overview about the idea you are going to discuss in your essay. *“Lahiri looks into the different attitudes of marriage from various perspectives such as from Ashoke and Ashima, Maxine, Moushumi and Gogol. The author clearly portrays the various opinions regarding a marriage which creates a cultural clash between Gogol’s idea and his parents’ idea.”*

Then you will give a summary on how you will answer this question including the various aspects you will be going into. *“Lahiri clearly portrays the different attitudes towards marriage through the characterisation of Gogol and his brought up, different language features, cultural clashes and themes. The author has used flashbacks and narration to portray the emotions of each character and their opinion on marriage.”*

PEEL paragraphs: PEEL stands for point, evidence, explanation and link, you may also use alternatives such as PEAL or PETAL which are similar to PEEL.

Point: Your point must be like a topic sentence, something that summarises what you are going to explain in your paragraph. It should include language devices, imagery, themes, motifs or characterisation. *“The author uses the relationships between Ashoke and Ashima to express their attitude towards marriage relating to the motif of cultural clashes.”* Your point should be no more than one sentence.

Evidence: Quote a line or two from the novel which relates to the question you are answering, since this is a prose you must select the most suitable quote that is related to the question you are answering. Having a quote more than 3 lines will make it hard to analyse the entire quote causing you to have less time for the other paragraphs.

Explanation: This part of your analysis will fetch you the most marks. Your explanation must explain the implicit and explicit meaning of the quote (despite it being a novel). If you are not using a quote you must explain the relationship between the idea you are analysing and the question. You must also include the emotions of the characters and relating to the themes, tones, moods and motifs. Moreover, you must include language features such as narration and flashback techniques to enhance your response.

One example is relating to the theme of the whole novel. *"The author portrays Ashoke and Ashima's attitude towards marriage to be old fashioned mainly because their marriage was arranged. This relates to the theme of culture and tradition as their view on marriage is a long term bond when tying a nuptial chain across the neck. However, Gogol understands a marriage is a bond of love which cannot be forced upon creating a cultural clash and portraying the idea around marriage."*

You can also use the different characters and their experiences about the idea of marriage to help your answer. *"Gogol's idea on marriage can be depicted to be westernised mainly because of his upbringing. His time with Moushumi expresses his idea of marriage to be a love bond between two people who understand each other and want to be with each other rather than his parents' idea of being bonded by a thread. Moreover, after his marriage with Moushumi he is understanding that Moushumi has fallen out of love with him and that a nuptial thread does not mean marriage to him, showcasing the theme of love and marriage."*

In thematic questions your explanations must be in depth and explain exactly what the character feels relating to the certain theme or idea. Moreover, you must use incidents that have happened in the novel to strengthen your answer. In addition to that, your answers must describe the character of the

person and their relation to the question. A tactical way to connect the incident to the person is to look out for any thematic evidence both have in common or any motifs that make a huge impact on the story.

It is not necessary to remember quotes from the entire novel, instead you can pick out at least 4–6 quotes based on one theme/motif which might appear in the exam. Make sure to remember quotes based on a certain incident which is important in the novel. You must have a total of at least 20–30 quotes memorised for thematic based questions, however, these can be short quotes such as 3–6 words. Quotes for thematic based questions do not need to be long ones as their main purpose is to convey the main theme/motif/idea of the question.

Link: In the link section of your paragraph you must link back to the question you are supposed to answer. *“The idea between Ashima and Ashoke’s marriage is clearly portrayed in the novel by showcasing a cultural idea and their attitude towards marriage.”* The best way to link your answers is to give a short summary of what you just analysed and use that to link it to the question, instead of picking out one small point. You can also summarise the effect of language if you have analysed any language techniques to help your analysis.

The link part must not deviate from the question or be vague in any terms, you must not say something like *“this shows the attitude of marriage.”* Here the word ‘this’ is vague as in your explanation section you explained many points related to the quote.

Conclusion: Your conclusion should just summarise what you have answered and in most cases include a personal response(if you have not included one in the introduction). *“The author has clearly brought out the various attitudes towards marriage in this novel using the different cultures of each of the characters.”*

You must also include any language devices/techniques, symbolism, motifs, themes and ideas you have used in your answer. *“Lahiri is able to create a*

sense of cultural clash using techniques such as characterisation, themes, motifs and language devices such as narration and flashback."

Finally your conclusion must include the overall idea the author is trying to convey and your personal response. *"These techniques have been used to achieve a main motif of difference of culture and tradition, successfully bringing out the main themes and motifs of the entire novel. Moreover, the idea of marriage is highlighted through various characters creating a sense of contrast and division."*

Common mistakes:

7. Do **not** refer to the author by his/her first name. You can refer to the author as: the author, the full name(Jhumpa Lahiri) or the last name(Lahiri).
8. Use formal language.
 - a. "The author talks about" ❌
 - b. "The author goes on about" ❌
 - c. "The author expresses" ✔️
 - d. "The author showcases" ✔️
 - e. "The author explains" ✔️
 - f. "The author suggests" ✔️
9. Do not deviate from what the question is asking. Your points must be in line with what the question is asking.
10. Do **not** under analyse or over analyse, your analysis must be related to the question and only have implicit/explicit/background information.
11. Do **not** get the gender of the author wrong, if you are unsure what the gender of the author is do **not** use the pronouns they/them, instead just refer to the author as "the author" or "(name)."
12. Link your paragraph points rather than keeping them as many points in one paragraph. It gives the examiner an idea that you are able to connect ideas in the novel and that you can analyse them easily.

Paper 2: Drama

You are given 2 questions to answer within 1 hour and 30 minutes. It is ideal to spend 35–40 minutes per question and to leave 5–10 minutes per question for checking.

Example play: Twelfth Night

Either 5(a) Read this passage carefully, and then answer the question that follows it:

[Enter MALVOLIO.]

Malvolio: My masters, are you mad? Or what are you? Have you no wit, manners, nor honesty, but to gabble like tinkers at this time of night? Do ye make an ale-house of my lady's house, that ye squeak out your coziers' catches without any mitigation or remorse of voice? Is there no respect of place, persons, nor time, in you?

Sir Toby: We did keep time, sir, in our catches. Sneek up!

Malvolio: Sir Toby, I must be round with you. My lady bade me tell you that, though she harbours you as her kinsman, she's nothing allied to your disorders. If you can separate yourself and your misdemeanours, you are welcome to the house; if not, and it would please you to take leave of her, she is very willing to bid you farewell.

Sir Toby [Sings]: Farewell, dear heart, since I must needs be gone.

Maria: Nay, good Sir Toby.

Clown [Sings]: His eyes do show his days are almost done.

Maria: Is't even so?

Sir Toby [Sings]: But I will never die.

[Falls down. Clown [Sings]: Sir Toby, there you lie.

Malvolio: This is much credit to you.

Sir Toby [Sings]: Shall I bid him go?

Clown [Sings]: What an if you do?

Sir Toby [Sings]: Shall I bid him go, and spare not?

Clown [Sings]: O, no, no, no, no, you dare not.

Sir Toby[Rising]: Out o' tune, sir! Ye lie. Art any more than a steward? Dost thou think, because thou art virtuous, there shall be no more cakes and ale?

Clown: Yes, by Saint Anne; and ginger shall be hot i' th' mouth too.

Sir Toby: Th'art i' th' right. Go, sir, rub your chain with crumbs. A stoup of wine,

Malvolio: Mistress Mary, if you priz'd my lady's favour at anything more than contempt, you would not give means for this uncivil rule; she shall know of it, by this hand.

[Exit. Malvolio]

Maria: Go shake your ears.

Sir Andrew: 'Twere as good a deed as to drink when a man's ahungry, to challenge him the field, and then to break promise with him and make a fool of him.

Sir Toby: Do't, knight. I'll write thee a challenge; or I'll deliver thy indignation to him by word of mouth.

Maria: Sweet Sir Toby, be patient for tonight; since the youth of the Count's was to-day with my lady, she is much out of quiet. For Monsieur Malvolio, let me alone with him; if I do not gull him into a nay-word, and make him a common recreation, do not think I have wit enough to lie straight in my bed. I know I can do it.

Q1 (a) In what ways does Shakespeare make this such a dramatic moment in the play?

Or

Q1 (b) Explore the ways in which Shakespeare strikingly portrays love in Twelfth Night.

How to answer Q1 (a)

Q1 (a) In what ways does Shakespeare make this such a dramatic moment in the play?

This question is based off of a given extract from the play, this is from Act 2 Scene 3. You must choose at least 4–6 quotes from the extract to support your answer. First look at the keywords of the question

‘Dramatic’ → This refers to the conflict/tension of the play, thematic evidence, characterization, setting and emotions. Whenever a question asks ‘how is this such a dramatic moment’ you must elaborate on these elements by using quotes to support your answer. You may also include the playwright’s intentions on the purpose of this scene and the relevance to the society(i.e. here it is the Elizabethan society).

Format for analysing prose: Introduction, 3–5 PEEL(point, evidence, explanation and link) paragraphs and a conclusion.

Introduction: In your introduction, firstly explain the entire play in one line or two lines but nothing more than two lines. *“The play ‘Twelfth Night’ written by the playwright William Shakespeare discusses various themes including love as a cause of suffering, appearance versus reality and comedy through characters and dialogues.”*

Next, you can give a summary of the scene you will be analysing. *“Act 2 scene 3 is a comedic scene between the characters Malvolio, Sir Toby, Sir Andrew, the clown and Maria. The scene depicts strong themes of hierarchy and elements of dramatic irony as Maria plans to get revenge on Malvolio.”*

Now, you will include the elements you are going to analyse in your answer. *"These ideas are brought out through the comedic dialogues between Sir Toby and the clown, the setting of the scene and using characterization the elements of dramatic irony and satire are showcased."*

Lastly, you must relate it to the real life context(Elizabethan society). *"This scene is made dramatic by connecting these elements to the methods of Elizabethan society and ideas of hierarchy."*

PEEL paragraphs: PEEL stands for point, evidence, explanation and link, you may also use alternatives such as PEAL or PETAL which are similar to PEEL.

Point: Your point must be like a topic sentence, something that summarises what you are going to explain in your paragraph. *"Firstly, Shakespeare uses the dialogues between Sir Toby and the clown to showcase the disrespect they give Malvolio highlighting the comedic effect."* Your point should be no more than one sentence only mentioning the main details, do not analyse the feature in your point.

Evidence: Choose the most suitable quote from the text making sure it is not more than 3 lines. If you choose a quote more than 3 lines, you make it more difficult for yourself to analyse as there will be so much to analyse in one paragraph which means you get less time for the other paragraphs. Since this is a play written in the Elizabethan era, if your quote has any element related to the Elizabethan era AND corresponds with the topic you will be explaining it is best to use this quote as there are many implicit meanings making it easier for analysis.

Explanation: This part of your analysis will fetch you the most marks. Your explanation must explain the implicit and explicit meaning of the quote. This play is written in the Elizabethan era so your answer must include a reference to the system in the Elizabethan era(i.e. the hierarchy). Your explanation must include either the setting, character, dialogue, elements(such as dramatic irony) or important thematic evidence that relates to the dramatic effect of the play.

You can talk about the language and the play on words. *"Sir Toby and the clown speak in colloquial language and in shorter lines compared to Malvolio who speaks in a more formal language (even though he is rebuking Sir Toby and the clown). This showcases the differences in hierarchy as it is considered that wealthier people who are higher in status speak in prose rather than verse, which significantly portrays the Elizabethan era and therefore makes the scene dramatic. Moreover, throughout the play Shakespeare portrays Malvolio as just a steward, however, he himself thinks of him in a higher ranking which brings out the irony as he tries to speak like higher ranked people as well."*

You can also talk about the disrespect Sir Toby gives to Malvolio as he continues to sing even though Malvolio tells him to stop. *"Shakespeare has clearly portrayed the opinions of Sir Toby and the clown about Malvolio and has portrayed the disrespect Malvolio gets. This brings out the theme of class, order and system in the play. The 'verbal dual' showcases the characters of Sir Toby as how he thinks to live life to the fullest and Malvolio who is strict and needs decorum. This conflict between ideas creates dramatic tension in the scene. Furthermore, constant bantering shown in the dialogues brings out the comic relief in the play and despite Malvolio scolds them to stop, both Sir Toby and the clown parallelly sing showcasing the comedic characters and how foolish Malvolio is creating a dramatic effect."*

Lastly, you may talk about Maria's plan for Malvolio foreshadowing events and themes that will be showcased. *"Maria's line towards the end of the scene is an example of foreshadowing of events that are going to happen as she plans to get revenge on Malvolio. This is significant in the play because it showcases the power Maria has over everyone and her cunning/manipulating character making the scene dramatic. This tension develops the play and sets the tone for further chaos and deception as well as ideas of class, order and system making this scene dramatic. Moreover, the foreshadowing depicts themes of madness and chaos making this scene dramatic and significant."*

Link: The link part of your answer should be like a short summary of what you have just explained and must link back to what the question is asking you to

analyse. *"The constant banter between Malvolio and Sir Toby creates ideas of class, order and system allowing the tone of hierarchy to be set making this scene dramatic."* The link part of the answer should not deviate from what you have just analysed and should not be so long that it takes away from the content of your answer. It is always best to relate it to any elements of the society(if any) eg. here the Elizabethan society.

The link part must not be vague in any terms, you must not say something like *"this makes this part of the extract dramatic."* Here the word 'this' is vague as in your explanation section you explained many points related to the quote.

Conclusion: Your conclusion should just summarise what you have answered and in most cases include a personal response(if you have not included one in the introduction). *"Shakespeare has successfully made this part of the play dramatic by the use of themes, tones, dramatic irony and characterization. He has been able to convey the idea of class, order and system in Elizabethan society and to what extent it is important in the play."*

You must also include any language devices/techniques, symbolism, motifs, themes and ideas you have used in your answer.

How to answer Q1 (b)

Q1 (b) Explore the ways in which Shakespeare strikingly portrays love in Twelfth Night.

This is a thematic based question or a question that asks you to showcase a certain idea being repeated in the entire play. Sometimes these questions could ask you about the character of a certain person. In each case it is suggested that you use some quotes to support your answer and to help you analyse. It is suggested because without quotes your answer may not be properly structured and therefore will be messy/shabby for the examiner to understand. You need to have at least 3–5 PEEL paragraphs with at least 1 quote in each paragraph.

In this question we are asked about the different ways love is portrayed. We can understand that the question is asking us to explain the themes related to love using different examples in the play.

Format for analysing prose: Introduction, 3–5 PEEL(point, evidence, explanation and link) paragraphs and a conclusion.

Introduction: In your introduction you explain what the prose is about in 1–2 sentences maximum, anything more than that is a waste of time you could use for the next part of the essay. *“The play ‘Twelfth Night’ written by William Shakespeare, explores various elements such as hierarchy, love as a cause of suffering and uses comedic and dramatic effects to portray these elements.”*

Next you must give an overview about the idea you are going to discuss in your essay. *“Shakespeare looks into the theme of love as a cause of suffering and strikingly portrays different types of love through the characters in the play. Moreover, the playwright gives an insight on the different ways love is expressed and accepted in the play making it very significant.”*

Then you will give a summary on how you will answer this question including the various aspects you will be going into. *“Shakespeare discusses this in various methods such as the characterization, themes, elements such as dramatic irony and opinions/emotions of the characters.”*

PEEL paragraphs: PEEL stands for point, evidence, explanation and link, you may also use alternatives such as PEAL or PETAL which are similar to PEEL.

Point: Your point must be like a topic sentence, something that summarises what you are going to explain in your paragraph. It should include language devices, imagery, themes or characterisation. *“The playwright uses appearance versus reality to showcase the different types of love in the play ‘Twelfth Night.’”* Your point should be no more than one sentence.

Evidence: Quote a line or two from the play which relates to the question you are answering, since this is a play you must select the most suitable quote that is related to the question you are answering. Having a quote more than 3 lines

will make it hard to analyse the entire quote causing you to have less time for the other paragraphs.

Explanation: This part of your analysis will fetch you the most marks. Your explanation must explain the implicit and explicit meaning of the quote (despite it being a novel). If you are not using a quote you must explain the relationship between the idea you are analysing and the question. You must also include the emotions of the characters and relating to the themes, tones, moods and motifs. Moreover, your quote may also have elements related to the society they live in, for example here the Elizabethan society.

One example could be the relationship between Olivia and Viola and the idea of mistaken identity is showcased here. *“The relationship between Olivia and Viola is an example of mistaken identity and appearance versus reality. The love Olivia has for Viola is justified to be a way of coping for the loss of her brother. Towards the end of the play, Shakespeare brings out the character of Sebastian who looks exactly like Cesario (Viola) and shows how Olivia is attracted to Sebastian now because of his physician traits. Olivia’s love is an example of physical attraction and gender confusion bringing out the themes of mistaken identity and appearance versus reality as well as strikingly portraying the idea of love as a cause of suffering.”*

You can also talk about the relationship between Olivia and Orsino and how Orsino’s love is just infatuation. *“Orsino’s love for Olivia is an example of infatuated and unrequited love. His love is not true for Olivia as towards the end of the play once he gets to know Cesario (Viola) is a lady he decides to marry Viola. Orsino is in love with the idea of being in love and he is in love with Olivia because of her social status bringing out the theme of class, order and system. Moreover, the dialogues spoken by Orsino are in verse rather than prose showcasing how he is deeply infatuated bringing out the types of love in the play.”*

Lastly, you can speak about Viola’s true love for Orsino. *“The love Viola has for Orsino is an example of true love even though it is unrequited. Viola is in love with Orsino because of his character and charm showcasing the only true love in the entire play. Despite Orsino loving someone else, Viola still pursues*

her love for Orsino which showcases the truth that is in her love and strikingly portrays the idea of love in the play. Moreover, Viola's compassion for Orsino is showcased when she puts Orsino's needs such as sending letters and poems to Olivia first rather than her own love which again depicts true love."

In thematic questions your explanations must be in depth and explain exactly what the character feels relating to the certain theme or idea. Moreover, you must use incidents that have happened in the play to strengthen your answer. In addition to that, your answers must describe the character of the person and their relation to the question. A tactical way to connect the incident to the person is to look out for any thematic evidence both have in common or any motifs that make a huge impact on the story.

It is not necessary to remember quotes from the entire play, instead you can pick out at least 4–6 quotes based on one theme/motif which might appear in the exam. Make sure to remember quotes based on a certain incident which is important in the play. You must have a total of at least 20–30 quotes memorised for thematic based questions, however, these can be short quotes such as 3–6 words. Quotes for thematic based questions do not need to be long ones as their main purpose is to convey the main theme/motif/idea of the question.

Link: In the link section of your paragraph you must link back to the question you are supposed to answer. *"Using elements of true love and Viola's character, Shakespeare is able strikingly portray the different types of love and bring out the theme of love as a cause of suffering in the play."* The best way to link your answers is to give a short summary of what you just analysed and use that to link it to the question, instead of picking out one small point. You can also summarise the effect of language if you have analysed any language techniques to help your analysis.

Conclusion: Your conclusion should just summarise what you have answered and in most cases include a personal response(if you have not included one in the introduction). *"Shakespeare has been able to successfully bring out the various elements of love and the different types of love. He has also been able*

to showcase the characteristics of each of the characters through their ideas on love."

You must also include any language devices/techniques, symbolism, motifs, themes and ideas you have used in your answer. *"He has done this by using elements such as themes, characterization, language devices and motifs of the play."*

Finally your conclusion must include the overall idea the author is trying to convey and your personal response. *"Using all these elements, Shakespeare has been able to use love as a cause of suffering throughout the play and bring out elements of Elizabethan society through ideas of class, order and system. The idea of love has been able to create a sense of compassion and understanding between the relationship that each character has with another."*

Common mistakes:

1. Do **not** refer to the playwright by his/her first name. You can refer to the playwright as: the playwright, the full name(William Shakespeare) or the last name(Shakespeare).
2. Use formal language.
 - a. "The playwright talks about" ❌
 - b. "The playwright goes on about" ❌
 - c. "The playwright expresses" ✔️
 - d. "The playwright showcases" ✔️
 - e. "The playwright explains" ✔️
 - f. "The playwright suggests" ✔️
3. Do not deviate from what the question is asking. Your points must be in line with what the question is asking.
4. Do **not** under analyse or over analyse, your analysis must be related to the question and only have implicit/explicit/background information
5. Do **not** get the gender of the playwright wrong, if you are unsure what the gender of the author is do **not** use the pronouns they/them, instead just refer to the playwright as "the playwright" or "(name)."

6. Link your paragraph points rather than keeping them as many points in one paragraph. It gives the examiner an idea that you are able to connect ideas in the novel and that you can analyse them easily.
7. When analysing, try connecting to the setting the play is meant to be in, here in Twelfth night it is Elizabethan Society. This will help you to understand why these themes are being brought out and the significance of these ideas which will help you when analysing.

Common tips when analysing literature answers:

When analysing literature answers it is important for you to think about these two questions: What has the poet/author/playwright used and why have they used it. When reading back from your answers try answering these questions and if your point has enough analyses you will find it to be justified and that's when you know you have a good answer. Furthermore, when analysing, think about the layers of an iceberg: Layers of ICE, quote, literal meaning, implicit meaning, connotations, and effects. Using these elements you can frame a proper answer with a solid analysis.

Secondary but main factor is the structure of your answer. It is always recommended to spend 3–5 minutes planning your answer. Create a mind-map or write down some points whatever suits you and use that to create a solid foundation on what you are going to analyse. You are always advised to go in chronological order when it comes to extract based analysis so plan your answer accordingly. Use PEEL or PETAL paragraphs to aid in analysing and to have a proper structure. Examiners do not like it when your analysis is scattered all over the place or if one part of the analysis is not discussed properly.

Language is a key factor in literature answers. Use formal language at all times because this is vital when showcasing your ideas. The use of language will help your answer seem more appealing and coherent for the examiner to read and

therefore will help them make sense of your answer. If you are vague about anything or you don't use proper language to convey your ideas, your answer will lose meaning and therefore you will get your marks cut.

Lastly, practice is key. Keep practising answers over and over again until you are able to formulate an answer which conveys proper meaning. You can send your answers to your teachers or give them to a friend to correct and give you solid feedback.



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